project.org

STUDENT HANDOUT

RED LEVEL
GO DEEPER

Seeing Through Deception

Grades 6–8 · Library

ADMIT ONE

NAME _____ DATE _____ CLASS _____

The evolution of visual deception. From daguerreotypes to deepfakes, each generation faces new forms of visual manipulation — and each generation believes they're too smart to be fooled.

01 PART 1

Research: Understanding deepfakes

Research deepfake technology and answer:

What is a deepfake and how is it created?

What are current methods for detecting deepfakes?

Why might detection become harder over time?

02

PART 2

Create a verification guide

Design a guide for your peers on how to evaluate visual media. Include:

- [ ] At least 3 red flags that suggest an image/video might be fake
- [ ] 3 steps they should take before believing visual content
- [ ] 2–3 resources for verification (reverse image search, fact-checking sites)
- [ ] One historical example showing this isn't a new problem

OUTLINE YOUR GUIDE HERE

03

PART 3

Critical question

If deepfake technology becomes perfect — completely undetectable — what skills will still protect people from being deceived? In other words, what verification methods are technology-proof?

MINI MUSEUM DEEP DIVE

William Mumler was acquitted in 1869 because prosecutors couldn't prove HOW he faked photos. As AI improves, we may face the same problem.

How should society handle deception that can't be technically proven?

minimuseumproject.org/exhibitions/seeing-is-deceiving/illusions

SHARE WITH YOUR FAMILY

Present your verification guide to your family. Discuss: What online content has fooled you or them? How could these methods have helped?